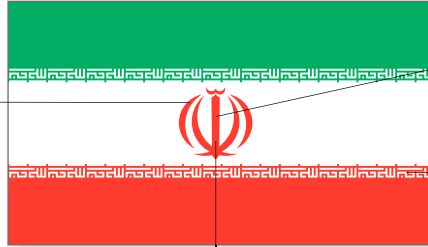


Iran

Ratio: 4:7 **Adopted:** July 29, 1980 **Usage:** National and Civil

The four crescents symbolize the growth of the Muslim faith



The sword represents strength and fortitude

Kufic script from the Qur'an

The globe shape stands for the power of the world's downtrodden people

Asia



Iran was a monarchy until 1979, when the Ayatollah Khomeini deposed the Shah. An Islamic republic was formed in 1980.

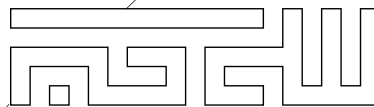
The traditional green, white, and red of the Iranian flag date back to the 18th century, although there is no agreed explanation of the colors. The colors were arranged in horizontal stripes in 1906. In 1980 a new flag was introduced with the addition of emblems expressive of the Islamic Revolution.

A REVOLUTIONARY EMBLEM

The emblem in the center of the flag is a highly stylized composite of various elements representing different facets of Islamic life: Allah, the Book, the Sword, the five principles of Islam, balance, unity, neutrality, and the universal government of the downtrodden.

THE KUFIC SCRIPT (STYLIZED VERSION)

Along the edges of the green and red stripes appears the phrase "Allahu Akbar" ("God is Great")



A stylized version of Kufic script, used for the Qur'an

The script, repeated 22 times, is the date in the Islamic calendar on which Ayatollah Khomeini returned from exile in 1979